First News

10 April 2026 Friday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

S&P 500 & Nasdaq post 7th straight gain on US-Iran cease-fire optimism.

- Oil: volatile near $98–$110 after sharp drop
- Gold: up to ~$4,800/oz
- Bitcoin: climbing near $71k on risk-on mood
- Relief rally in play, but truce still fragile.

The U.S. is pushing Israel to low-key military actions to save the Iran ceasefire, but Netanyahu is doubling down. By insisting the truce doesn't cover Lebanon Continued strikes risk collapsing the Islamabad talks, sinks U.S. deeper into a war it's trying to exit.

Oil Rises in Choppy Session as Saudi Supplies Hit By Attacks Gold & Silver steady

Qatar is mobilizing, to resume production at the Ras Laffan LNG facility following a ceasefire.. Production to resume tommorow marking a major step toward restoring 17% of Qatar’s annual export capacity that was taken offline by a missile attack in early March.

The White House is sending JD Vance to negotiate with Tehran in Pakistan this weekend.

Equities: Investors are optimistic but wary; the ceasefire is only for two weeks, and any violation could quickly reverse gains.

- Oil may find support near the $90–$95 zone if the ceasefire holds.
- Gold is eyeing a potential push toward $5,000 if central bank demand persists.

U.S. Treasury Yields:

- Rates remained elevated but steady.
- The 10-year yield hovered around 4.30%.

Bitcoin

- Remained relatively cautious, trading below the $75,000 threshold.
- While it benefited from the general "risk-on" sentiment, it did not match the explosive gains seen in equities.

Metals

- Copper and silver remained near record highs due to strong long-term demand and a weaker dollar, though they faced short-term volatility as traders reassessed risk premiums.
- Gold: Prices rose to record intraday highs near $4,850/oz. While geopolitical easing usually hurts safe havens, gold was supported by a weaker U.S. dollar and cooling inflation fears as oil prices crashed.

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Global, Regional Markets

ASIA

- Asian markets are experiencing a tug-of-war, with Japanese stocks surging on a massive $18.65b foreign influx driven by seasonal dividend buying.
- However, broader regional gains, KOSPI & Shanghai, are capped by rising geopolitical uncertainty, on a fragile US-Iran ceasefire.

April 9

Wall Street witnessed a massive rally while oil prices plummeted following the announcement of a two-week ceasefire between the U.S. and Iran. The agreement includes the crucial reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, easing fears of a severe global energy supply shock.

- Major indexes surged on the de-escalation news.
- The Dow Jones jumped over 1,300 points (+2.85%), the S&P 500 rose 2.51%, and the Nasdaq gained 2.80%.
- Mega-cap tech led the charge, with Meta Platforms rallying 6.5% after debuting its "Muse Spark" AI model.

Oil: Prices suffered their steepest drop since 2020.

- WTI Crude tumbled approximately 15–17%, falling below $95 a barrel as the "war premium" evaporated with the reopening of key shipping lanes.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	46,584	48,185	3.44%
S&P 500	6,616	6,824	3.14%
NASDAQ	22,017	22,822	3.66%
PCOMP	5,957	6,089	2.22%
NKY	53,429	55,895	4.62%
SHCOMP	3890	3966	1.95%
HSI	25,116	25,752	2.53%
KOSPI	5494	5778	5.17%
SENSEX	74,616	76,631	2.70%
TWSE	33,229	34,861	4.91%
ASX200	8728	8973	2.81%
BURSAKLCI	1676	1686	0.60%
JCI	6971	7307	4.82%
STI	4958	4977	0.38%
SET	974	985	1.13%
VNINDEX	1677	1736	3.52%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	4/8/2026	4/10/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	96.51	98.5	2.06%
Brent Crude	93.46	96.67	3.43%
Gold (Comex)	4863	4781	-1.69%
Silver (Comex)	76.62	75.32	-1.70%
Copper (Comex)	568.35	575	1.17%
Nickel	7.7005	7.7118	0.15%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	77	76.5	-0.65%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	93	92.5	-0.54%
Coal	138.5	135.5	-2.17%
Corn	443.25	445.5	0.51%
Wheat	582.25	575.25	-1.20%
Cocoa	3028	3240	7.00%
Sugar	14.58	13.92	-4.53%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

It was a huge "relief rally"; the PSEI gained 2.22% with all groups positive. Mining/Oil, Property, and Banks tracked the most gains. Services, conglomerates, and industrials gained likewise.

Philippines's long-term foreign & local currency debt rating was affirmed by S&P at BBB+. Outlook to stable from positive Stable outlook reflects expectation that the Philippines willmaintain healthy economic growth and its fiscal deficit will decline over the next two years

USD/PHP
Dissolving "Safe-Haven" Demand: During the peak of the conflict, investors rushed to the US dollar for safety. The ceasefire removed this "war premium," prompting a massive exit from dollar positions

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

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6089 +132.04pts., 0.2.22%

Range 6,061.53-6,114.26

Breadth 158 (+) 47 (-) 57 (unch)

Block Php1.07bn **Volume** 1.12bn **Value** Php8.32bn

Share buyback MEG OPM AGI

52wk H: sgp
52wk L: gsmi pha prim rci

Overbought – dmw agi axlm rrhi vita cic spnec
Oversold – gsmi abs tfhi cbc pha

Active	Value
ICT	753
BDO	727
ALI	629
JFC	543
MBT	446
URC	440
BPI	257
APX	255
PLUS	216

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$7.361mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$96.132mn
YTD NFB	$84.294mn
FB	3,392,286,234.14
FS	3,829,734,661.01
NFB(S)	-437,448,426.87
TOTAL	7,222,020,895.15

Foreign Funds Bought
bdo cbc mbt pnb secb dhi mfc slf ap fgen pcor scc sgp top axlm monde mwide imi aev dmc fdc jgs ltg cli creit filrt mreit rock shng dito glo ceb ict mac bloom plus alldy pgold ab apx at marc px

Foreign Funds Sold
bpi pse acen mer mwc mynld shlph spnec cnpf dnl emi gsmi jfc keepr rfm urc cic ac agi cosco gtcap lpz sm ali areit meg rcr smph tel cnvrg web rrhi nikl ogp

Global Funds Net Buyers
Wednesday 4/8/26: ICT GLO SGP CREIT BDO MBT PNB APX PX SCC PLUS IMI AEV JGS DMC LTG AP PGOLD MONDE MAC

	4/8/2…	4/10…	%Chg
10yr Bond			
PHL	6.705	6.606	-1.48%
US	4.254	4.284	0.71%
Currency Pair			
USD-JPY	159.83	159.21	0.64%
USD-PHP	60.304	59.753	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.863	6.8383	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1577	1.1685	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ALTER 0.78

- Alternergy Holdings Corp. has received regulatory approval for a shelf registration of up to 50m Green Perpetual Preferred Shares to raise as much as ₱5b over the next 5 years.
- Providing the RE ALTER a flexible capital buffer to fund its project pipeline

SCC 30.00

- P/E 9.8x
- 52 wk Range 21.20 - 36
- Revenue 52.232B
- Net Income 13.06B
- EPS 3.07
- Dividend (Yield)3.25 (10.8%)
- Dip buy
- Potential Gain: 16.67% (calculated from the current price of 30.0 to the target of 35.0)

SEC: Mutual Fund Guidelines

- **The Securities and Exchange Commission released final umbrella mutual fund guidelines, allowing a single entity to house multiple sub-funds with different mandates (equity, fixed income, balanced, money market, index).**
- SEC Chairman Francis Lim cited the current one-fund-per-company constraint as a growth bottleneck. Under the rules, an umbrella fund must maintain ≥2 sub-funds; each sub-fund issues one security type; existing open-end funds may convert via articles amendment. Six-month compliance window from first sub-fund approval.
- Implication: Incrementally positive for PSE market depth and financial inclusion. Near-term beneficiaries include fund management arms of BPI, GTCAP/Metrobank, and AC/Ayala group which have the AUM scale to immediately rationalize multiple fund structures under one umbrella. No direct single-ticker catalyst today, but the regulatory direction is constructive for broader investor participation.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ACEN 3.00

- ACEN Corp. President and CEO Eric Francia told reporters on the sidelines of the 2026 Philippine Energy Forum that the company is finding an unexpected commercial opportunity in the Middle East crisis: surplus renewable energy inventory that can now be offered competitively to retail electricity customers. "The silver lining is we have excess power to sell to customers. So, this is a good time to offer our renewable energy product to customers because we do have inventory," he said. Francia noted that ACEN's existing power plants are not materially impacted by the war given their fuel-free and fixed-tariff structures, though supply chain disruptions and higher capital costs from rising interest rates and inflation could pressure future capex. He confirmed that 2026 financial performance is expected to be materially stronger than 2025's ₱3.8 billion net income — driven by Ilocos Norte wind restoration, new Australian and Laos plant contributions, and improved spot market conditions. ACEN operates in the Philippines, Australia, Vietnam, India, Indonesia, Laos, and the US.
- **Analysis:** ACEN's "silver lining" framing is commercially astute: as fossil fuel prices soar, ACEN's fully renewable, fixed-tariff power becomes relatively more competitive, enabling it to capture market share from conventional suppliers through its retail electricity supply (RES) business. The excess inventory signal also suggests the company is better positioned than feared for spot market conditions in 2026. The key risk to monitor is inflation-driven capex cost pressure on new project construction — a theme Francia himself flagged — particularly for the Australia battery storage (200 MW New England BESS, targeted H1 2026 completion) and India projects (Tejorupa, Sheo 1&2 hybrid, Bijapur wind). The May 7 earnings release will be the definitive test of whether the 2026 profitability recovery story is tracking.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE. Position ahead of May 7 earnings; target ₱3.50 with a 12-month view.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

AVIATION, TOURISM

- Philippine Airlines (PAL) resumed Manila-Riyadh service on April 10 via an alternate routing with a technical refueling stop in Bangkok — the first restoration of any Meralco [sic] Middle East route since the conflict-era suspensions. The resumption follows the April 8 announcement of a two-week US-Iran ceasefire, which triggered a cautious reopening of regional aviation corridors. PAL had earlier suspended Riyadh (until April 8), Dubai and Doha (until April 30) routes, and domestically impacted Siargao, Ozamiz, and Calbayog services.
- Cebu Pacific has extended its Manila-Dubai suspension through at least end-April, reflecting a more conservative risk assessment. Iraqi airspace reopened on April 8, partially restoring a central aviation corridor between Europe and the Gulf, but Iran, Kuwait, and Bahrain remain closed to commercial traffic. Jet fuel costs remain elevated and airline operating economics have not normalized.
- **Analysis:** The ceasefire is a two-week pause, not a resolution — airline scheduling will remain volatile. For Philippine carriers, the critical consideration is the OFW remittance channel: PAL and Cebu Pacific serve as lifelines for over 2 million Filipinos in the Middle East. Any sustained resumption of Gulf services is therefore both commercial and social in significance. The alternate Bangkok-stop routing implies higher fuel burn, longer block times, and reduced economics per flight. At current Brent crude (~$115/bbl), Middle East routes remain marginal even if airspace is clear. The ceasefire is net positive for aviation sentiment, but investors should expect no near-term return to normal capacity or profitability. PAL is not listed; Cebu Air (CEB) is the listed proxy.
- **Stance:** MONITOR. Avoid until ceasefire converts to a durable peace and jet fuel economics improve.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MER 610.50

- **Meralco Senior Vice President Arnel Casanova called on electric cooperatives in Batangas (Batelec I) and General Santos City (SOCOTECO II) to conduct public bidding to select distribution upgrade partners, warning that delays are hurting power consumers in both areas.** Meralco — which currently serves only selected industrial and special economic zones in Batangas — submitted a formal proposal years ago to expand its franchise coverage in the province, where consumers suffer frequent and prolonged outages. In GenSan, Meralco's privatization proposal for SOCOTECO II competes against Ignite Power and Energy Corp., a Manny Pacquiao-Enrique Razon joint venture. Casanova was clear that Meralco's model preserves cooperative assets and workforce but converts SOCOTECO II into a stock corporation — the first cooperative incorporation of its kind in the Philippines. He argued that a transparent bidding process is the most consumer-protective path forward, per BusinessWorld (April 9, 2026).
- **Analysis:** Meralco's franchise expansion ambitions in Batangas and GenSan represent a longer-term volume growth vector for MER. The competitive bid process in GenSan pits Meralco's deep capital and operational expertise against Ignite Power's political and reputational assets (Pacquiao's local ties, Razon's infrastructure track record). Outcome uncertainty is high. For Batangas, the scale of unmet demand — 2,000 Laiya residents recently petitioned for Meralco coverage — underscores the organic growth opportunity. Near-term EPS impact is minimal; this is a 2027–2028 earnings story if franchise awards proceed. The energy emergency context could paradoxically accelerate approval timelines as regulators prioritize supply reliability.
- **Stance:** MONITOR. Track bidding timelines. A GenSan award to Meralco would be a positive re-rating catalyst.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MEG 2.09

- Andrew Tan-led Megaworld Corp. secured LEED Gold certification for Enterprise Two, a 12-storey office tower within its 72-hectare Iloilo Business Park in Mandurriao, Iloilo City, bringing the developer's total roster of LEED-certified and registered office properties to 32 — the highest in the Philippine real estate industry. The building offers 39,000 square meters of gross leasable area, with floor plates of up to 4,000 sqm designed to accommodate IT-BPM and corporate tenants expanding beyond Metro Manila. Enterprise Two is the second LEED Gold-certified building in Western Visayas, following Enterprise One at the same township. Megaworld now holds 12 LEED Gold and 12 LEED Silver certified towers, with additional certifications expected within the year. Green features include rainwater harvesting, double-glazed windows, reflective roof coatings, and EV charging infrastructure
- **Analysis:** Megaworld's LEED leadership reinforces its positioning as the preferred landlord for multinational and Fortune 500 IT-BPM tenants that impose ESG standards on their real estate partners — evidenced by its landmark JP Morgan Chase agreement covering 150,000 sqm across two LEED-certified towers. Enterprise Two's certification signals the company's ambitions to deepen its Iloilo foothold, a market where it already commands the largest office inventory. Strategically, regional office markets like Iloilo are more resilient to Metro Manila macro headwinds as provincial BPO demand is driven by cost arbitrage and talent accessibility rather than OFW remittance flows. At the current price of ~₱2.09/share, MEG trades at a meaningful discount to book — the LEED milestone strengthens the qualitative case for its green leasing premium.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/7/2026	4/8/2026	%Chg
AC	537	540.5	0.65%
ACEN	3.03	3	-0.99%
AEV	29.85	30.25	1.34%
ALI	16.9	18.4	8.88%
AREIT	39.2	39.75	1.40%
BDO	117.9	123.1	4.41%
BPI	102.5	104.1	1.56%
CBC	61.95	62.5	0.89%
CNPF	32.2	33.3	3.42%
CNVRG	12.3	12.34	0.33%
DMC	10.1	10.2	0.99%
EMI	15.14	15.46	2.11%
GLO	1,645.00	1,651.00	0.36%
GTCAP	520	522	0.38%
ICT	685	699	2.04%
JFC	169.9	172.5	1.53%
JGS	27.85	29	

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/7/2026	4/8/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.38	14.8	2.92%
MBT	64.4	64.4	0.00%
MER	614	610.5	-0.57%
MONDE	6.58	6.7	1.82%
PGOLD	40.7	41.9	2.95%
PLUS	15.88	16.96	6.80%
RCR	6.8	6.95	2.21%
SCC	29.4	30	2.04%
SM	608.5	623.5	2.47%
SMC	69	69.5	0.72%
SMPH	19.92	21	5.42%
TEL	1,290.00	1,290.00	0.00%
URC	63	62.5	-0.79%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	4/7/2026	4/8/2026	%Chg
AREIT	39.2	39.75	1.40%
CBC	61.95	62.5	0.89%
CREIT	3.44	3.49	1.45%
DMC	10.1	10.2	0.99%
DNL	3.65	3.76	3.01%
GLO	1,645.00	1,651.00	0.36%
LTG	14.38	14.8	2.92%
MBT	64.4	64.4	0.00%
MER	614	610.5	-0.57%
MREIT	13.8	13.92	0.87%
NIKL	4.5	4.72	4.89%
OGP	33.5	35	4.48%
PGOLD	40.7	41.9	2.95%
RCR	6.8	6.95	2.21%
RLC	17.3	17.54	1.39%
RRHI	45.7	45.85	0.33%
SCC	29.4	30	2.04%
SGP	22.4	22.8	1.79%
TEL	1,290.00	1,290.00	0.00%
URC	63	62.5	-0.79%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	4/7/2026	4/8/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.98	10	0.20%
APX	15.8	17.38	10.00%
AUB	42	42.1	0.24%
BLOOM	2.06	2.17	5.34%
COSCO	7.01	7.04	0.43%
DNL	3.65	3.76	3.01%
GSMI	272	270	-0.74%
KEEPR	2.12	2.15	1.42%
MEG	2.07	2.09	0.97%
MREIT	13.8	13.92	0.87%
MWC	42.45	43.5	2.47%
NIKL	4.5	4.72	4.89%
OGP	33.5	35	4.48%
PNB	56.3	57.6	2.31%
RLC	17.3	17.54	1.39%
RRHI	45.7	45.85	0.33%
SECB	65.85	67.5	2.51%
SEVN	34.5	35.5	2.90%
SGP	22.4	22.8	1.79%
WLCON	6.2	6.46	4.19%